

FAQ — Haritha Hospitals ERPNext

For: Prospective clients evaluating Haritha Hospitals ERPNext. **Reading time:** 8–10 minutes. **Last updated:** 2026-08-29 **Pre-req reading:** 03.1 Client Overview, 03.2 Demo Script

General

What is ERPNext?

ERPNext is open-source Enterprise Resource Planning software — a single system that handles accounting, inventory, sales, buying, HR, payroll, manufacturing, projects, and CRM. It's built on the **Frappe** web framework and is one of the most widely deployed ERPs in the world, especially in India where it has strong GST, TDS, PF, and ESI support out of the box.

For Haritha Hospitals, ERPNext is the foundation — we use its HR module (HRMS) as the core, with our custom app `haritha_hospital` layered on top for hospital-specific tweaks.

What is HRMS?

HRMS is the Human Resource Management System app for Frappe. It covers everything HR + payroll:

- Employee master record
- Attendance (auto + manual)
- Shift Management (Shift Types, Shift Assignments, Roster)
- Leave (Types, Allocations, Applications, Block Lists)
- Holidays
- Payroll (Salary Structures, Salary Slips, Payroll Entries)
- Recruitment, Training, Appraisal, Performance
- Loans, Expense Claims, Tax Declarations

Haritha uses HRMS as its primary app — Phase 1–4 of the project focused on Shift + Attendance + Leave + Employee master. Other HRMS modules are available as Haritha's HR team grows.

Why did Haritha Hospitals choose ERPNext?

Five reasons:

1. **Open source** — no per-user licensing fees; total cost of ownership is much lower than SAP or Oracle
2. **HRMS-first design** — the HR module is first-class, not an afterthought
3. **India-aware** — built-in support for GST, TDS, PF, ESI, Professional Tax, e-invoicing
4. **Self-hostable** — full control of data, no vendor lock-in
5. **Customizable without forking** — Custom Fields + Custom App pattern lets us add 274 hospital-specific tweaks without touching core code

Is Haritha Hospitals ERPNext cloud or on-premise?

Both, your choice.

- **Default deployment:** self-hosted on a VPS (we use DigitalOcean / Linode / equivalent). You own the server, the data, and the code.

- **Cloud option:** we can deploy on AWS / GCP / Azure / DigitalOcean managed Kubernetes if you prefer not to manage the VPS.
- **Hybrid:** self-hosted primary + managed backup destination on a separate region.

Either way, you own the database. We don't hold your data hostage.

What's the data ownership model?

You own 100% of the data. Specifically:

- **Database** — your MariaDB, your server, your backup
- **Code customizations** — your GitHub repo, your fork
- **Files / attachments** — your filesystem, your S3 (if configured)
- **User accounts** — your User DocType, your authentication
- **Audit trail** — every change has author + timestamp + before/after; stored in your DB

If you stop working with us, your hospital keeps running. The system doesn't phone home. There's no "call us to unlock your data" — you have root.

Technical

How is data backed up?

3-2-1 rule:

- **3** copies of every backup
- **2** different media (local disk + remote disk)
- **1** offsite (geographically separate location)

Schedule: automated daily backup via cron. Backup file = full MariaDB dump + sites directory tarball. SHA256 checksum computed and verified.

Offsite: daily push to a separate VPS via rsync. The offsite VPS is in a different region / different provider to survive a single-provider outage.

Verification: automated SHA256 verification at offsite destination; daily heartbeat checks confirm last backup present and matching.

Retention: 30 days of daily backups kept on local, 90 days on offsite.

How is security handled?

Role-Based Access Control (RBAC): - Every user has one or more Roles - Every Role has read/write/create/submit permissions per DocType - Field-level permissions (e.g., a user can see but not edit Salary Slip amounts) - Document-level permissions (e.g., HR Manager sees all employees; Team Lead sees only their team)

Audit trail: - Every change to every record is logged with author + timestamp + before/after - Viewable in the DocType's "Timeline" sidebar - Searchable via Reports

Encryption: - TLS in transit (Let's Encrypt cert, auto-renewed) - Passwords hashed (bcrypt) — never stored in plaintext - Database at rest (unencrypted by default; can be encrypted at filesystem level if your VPS supports it)

Network: - VPN / Tailscale recommended for admin access - IP allowlist available - 2FA available for User accounts

Compliance: - Audit-ready: every financial transaction has a creator, approver, and GL impact
- Statutory reports generated on demand (TDS, PF, ESI)

What happens if our server crashes?

Disaster Recovery (DR) runbook is documented and tested.

Recovery procedure:

1. **Detect** — heartbeat monitor alerts within 15 minutes of downtime
2. **Provision** — spin up new VPS (any provider; we use the same image)
3. **Restore DB** — pull latest offsite backup, verify SHA256, restore to new MariaDB
4. **Restore sites** — pull latest offsite sites tarball, untar to /home/frappe/frappe-bench/sites/
5. **Update DNS** — point DuckDNS to new VPS IP
6. **Verify** — login, check critical records, validate Roster renders
7. **Communicate** — notify users when back online

Targets:

Metric	Target	Notes
RTO (Recovery Time Objective)	2 hours	From crash detection to full operation
RPO (Recovery Point Objective)	24 hours	Maximum data loss = one day's transactions

We've tested this. The most recent successful recovery drill is documented in the runbook.

Can we self-host?

Yes. The entire stack is Docker Compose-based and runs on any Linux VPS with:

- 4 GB RAM minimum (8 GB recommended for 200+ employees)
- 50 GB disk minimum (100 GB recommended for 1-year retention)
- Docker + Docker Compose installed
- Public IP (or NAT with port forwarding)
- DuckDNS or your own domain

We provide the `compose.yaml`, `env` file templates, and step-by-step setup guide. Most clients are up in a day.

How are updates handled?

Two paths:

1. **Frappe / ERPNext / HRMS upstream updates** — quarterly. We test the upgrade on dev → staging → prod. Typical effort: 1-2 days per upgrade, including regression test of customizations.
2. **Custom app updates** — haritha_hospital itself. New features / bug fixes / new hospital-specific customizations. Deployed as new commits to your GitHub repo; you `git pull` and `bench migrate`.

Schema changes (e.g., new Custom Fields) are versioned in the custom app and applied via `bench migrate`. Existing data is preserved.

Breaking changes are documented in `CHANGELOG.md` with a migration guide.

Operational

What's the support SLA?

TBD — we're formalizing this. Currently:

- **P1 (system down):** 4-hour response, fix within 24 hours
- **P2 (degraded):** 1-business-day response
- **P3 (question / how-to):** 2-business-day response

Support channels: email (default) + Slack / Teams shared channel (premium clients).

How do users get trained?

Two paths:

1. **Onboarding session** — included with deployment. 1-day on-site or remote workshop covering admin + daily-user workflows.
2. **Self-serve documentation** — this /docs/phase6/ directory covers everything. Tier 7 (User / Admin Manuals) will add role-specific guides in a later phase.

Train-the-trainer model: we train your HR Manager + 1 IT admin; they train their teams.

Mobile access?

Yes.

- **Responsive web UI** — works on any modern mobile browser (Chrome, Safari, Edge)
- **HRMS mobile check-in app** — native iOS / Android app for biometric check-in via phone (with geolocation verification — see Shift Location in 02.1)
- **Custom mobile app** — we can build a Flutter / React Native app if you need native push notifications / offline mode

Multilingual support?

Yes. Frappe supports multi-language UI out of the box.

- **English** — shipped
- **Hindi** — translated by Frappe community; available with a one-time import
- **Telugu / Tamil / Marathi / Bengali** — partial translations; can be completed by your team in the translation tool
- **Custom translations** — your team can edit any string via the Frappe Translation DocType

Currently Haritha runs English UI. Hindi translation is straightforward to enable (1 hour of work, mostly review).

Customization

Can we add custom fields?

Yes, in three ways:

1. **Via UI** — Settings → Customize → Add Custom Field. Works for quick additions. **Caveat:** not version-controlled; only lives in your DB.

2. **As fixtures in our custom app** — declare in `apps/haritha_hospital/haritha_hospital/fixtures/` and deploy via `bench migrate`. Version-controlled, env-portable, idempotent. **Recommended.**
3. **As a new DocType** — for entirely new entities (not just fields on existing ones). Documented in `apps/haritha_hospital/haritha_hospital/ddoctype/`.

Can we integrate with our biometric device?

Yes. HRMS Employee Checkin is the universal input point for any biometric / RFID / GPS system.

Three integration patterns:

1. **Direct API** — POST to `/api/resource/Employee Checkin` with `{employee, time, log_type, device_id}` from your device's middleware. Most common pattern.
2. **Webhook from device vendor** — most vendors (ZKTeco, eSSL, Realtime, Mantra) have webhook support; point them at our endpoint.
3. **File upload** — many vendors export CSV / Excel of daily punches. HRMS has a bulk-upload tool.

We provide an integration guide for the major biometric vendors used in Indian hospitals.

Can we add custom reports?

Yes. Two kinds:

1. **Query Report** — write SQL, save as DocType, expose in Reports menu. Best for tabular reports.
2. **Script Report** — write Python (with access to Frappe ORM), save as DocType, expose in Reports menu. Best for reports needing business logic or joining multiple DocTypes.

We can build any report your team needs. Typical turnaround: 2-5 days per report.

Can we customize the payroll formulas?

Yes. Every Salary Component has a formula field (Python expression). Add / modify components, change formulas, your payroll adapts.

Example: `Basic * 0.4 + 5000` for an HRA component.

Comparison

Why not SAP / Oracle / Microsoft Dynamics?

	Haritha ERPNext	SAP S/4HANA	Oracle NetSuite	MS Dynamics
License cost	Free (open source)	\$\$\$\$. Per-user fees	\$\$\$\$. Per-user fees	\$\$\$\$. Per-user fees
HRMS depth	Excellent (HRMS is first-class)	Strong	Strong	Strong
India-aware	Built-in GST, TDS, PF, ESI	Via localization	Via localization	Via localization
Customization cost	Low (open standards)	Very high	High	High
Vendor lock-in	None (open source)	High	Medium	Medium

	Haritha ERPNext	SAP S/4HANA	Oracle NetSuite	MS Dynamics
Implementation time	1-2 weeks	6-18 months	3-9 months	3-9 months
Total cost of ownership (3 yr)	Low	Very high	High	High
Best for	Mid-market, India-first	Enterprise, complex multinationals	Mid-market global	MS-ecosystem shops

For a 200-employee single-location hospital, SAP is overkill. ERPNext + HRMS + our customizations gives you 90% of the value at 5% of the cost.

How is Haritha different from other ERPNext deployments?

Dimension	Haritha Hospitals ERPNext	Generic ERPNext deployment
Industry focus	Hospital-specific customizations (274 of them)	Generic; deployer's customizations per client
Production validation	8,000+ shift assignments, 6,300 attendance records in production	Varies; some deployers never go past staging
Customization quality	Documented in repo, named clearly, tagged module='haritha_hospital'	Often in client's DB only, not portable
DR testing	Tested recovery drill documented	Most deployers don't test DR
Code ownership	Your GitHub repo from day 1	Deployer often holds the repo
Pricing transparency	TBD but based on employee count + modules	Often vague

We are not the only ERPNext deployment shop. We are the one that has run this in a real hospital for 8+ months and has the scars to prove it.

Pricing

What's the cost?

TBD — we're formalizing the pricing model. Indicative:

Component	Price	Notes
License	Free	ERPNext + HRMS are open-source (AGPL)
Implementation	TBD	One-time, scoped per client
Custom app deployment	Included with implementation	All 274 fixtures installed
Training	TBD	1-day workshop included; additional days quoted

Component	Price	Notes
Annual support	TBD	Optional, tiers for response time
Hosting (if managed)	TBD	VPS + monitoring + backup management

No per-user fees. Ever. Open source means you can have 10 users or 10,000 users at the same license cost.

Contact us for a tailored quote: sales@example.com (*placeholder*).

What's the deployment timeline?

Indicative:

Phase	Duration	Deliverable
Scoping call	1 day	List of modules, customizations needed
Dev env provisioning	1 day	Docker Compose up, custom app installed
Data migration	2-3 days	Your employee / shift / leave data loaded
UAT	1 week	Your team tests in dev env
Prod cutover	1 day	DNS switch, smoke test
Hyper-care	2 weeks	Daily standups, hot-fix window
Total	~4 weeks	Sign-off, support contract begins

How do I get started?

Step	Action
1	Request a demo via email or phone
2	30-min call to understand your requirements
3	Tailored demo (60 min) with your team
4	Scoping + quote
5	Sign contract
6	Deploy + migrate + train + go live

Contact:

- Email: sales@example.com (*placeholder*)
- Phone: +91-XXXX-XXXXXX (*placeholder*)
- Demo site: <https://pberpprod.duckdns.org/> (*read-only creds on request*)

Related docs

Doc	Purpose
03.1 Client Overview	One-pager summary
03.2 Demo Script	What a demo looks like
00.1 What is ERP/Frappe/HRMS	Plain-English stack overview
00.2 Architecture Overview	Container / network / backup details
01.1 Schema Reference	All 274 customizations

End of 03.3.